



Photograph Thamizhelango Natarajan

Each month, *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 15<sup>th</sup> of this month.

# Beat That!

**Digit Caption**

**"Tech Armour"**

**Last Month's Winner!**

Anurag,  
Near Shakti Kunj, Yadav Nagar,  
Muzaffarpur - 842001

**"MS Office XPee"**



E-mail your caption with the subject 'Beat That', and your postal address, to [beatthat@thinkdigit.com](mailto:beatthat@thinkdigit.com)

and win  
**Leadership the Challenge**

by Kouzes and Posner  
Published by

**WILEY-INDIA**



has metal studs outside the casing to which wires are connected. The technology being used here is TSV (Through-Silicon Vias), which was developed by Tru-Si, a company in the US that Intel holds stake in. This technology was developed to try and do away with the bandwidth restrictions imposed on chips because of motherboards and the distances that data has to travel across them, from one chip to another.

TSV will help make motherboards and circuit boards smaller, as well as reduce overall dimensions of everything from PCs to mobile phones. Add to this the enhanced bandwidth available for communication with various chips, and you have a promising solution. Well, Samsung, for one, seems to be sure that it's the way to go. Of course it's not like you'll even know when it hits the markets, because all this is on the micro scale and inside your phone casing. Get ready for smaller and more powerful

Samsung phones, though actually, we'd rather people solved the display problems in mobile devices!

**A PATENT ISSUE AGAIN**

## Apple's Software Bubble Burst

**B**urst.com, a patent holder for a technology that speeds up streaming of audio and video content over the Internet, is suing Apple over its iTunes software and streaming QuickTime and iPod software.

Burst claims that it holds the patent for sending streaming audio and video over the Internet faster than real-time: when you receive signal reception on a TV it's in real-time, but when you stream, say, 30 minutes of video or audio from a server in anything less than 30 minutes, you're infringing on Burst's patent!

Ridiculous as this may sound, this is not the first

time Burst has humbled a large corporation into accepting their patent rights. Just last year, Burst reached an out-of-court settlement with Microsoft (Burst had sued them as well), and Microsoft coughed up \$60 million (Rs 270 crore) to get licensing from Burst for their patented method of accelerated streaming of audio and video.

Apple, however, is not about to part with their money that easily, and claims that Burst does not have valid claims to the patents. Sometime in 2004, Burst approached Apple to demand that Apple buy licensing for their usage of the technology that Burst has patents for. However, the talks broke down after Apple claimed that "Burst.com's attorneys threatened litigation against Apple." What followed was a "declaratory relief complaint" by Apple against Burst's claims to the patents in question.

Apple has decided to leave the ruling to the courts, but things do not

look good for the iPod creators. According to the countersuit filed by Burst, three of the four patents that Apple is calling "invalid" are the same patents that Burst used to sue Microsoft. Since a previous company (Microsoft, at that) has already accepted these patents after a lawsuit, and has bought licensing from Burst, we honestly don't think Apple has a chance!

**SENDER ID**

## MS Pushes E-Mail Verification Software

**I**n a renewed attempt to push for adoption of its Sender ID verification software, Microsoft will soon announce the results of its tests with the software on their own Hotmail service.

Microsoft has always been one of the most avid